

SEX INHERITANCE

The sex chromosomes are one pair of the 23 pairs in a human.

In females, they are seen as two "X's".

i.e. XX is a female.

In males, they are seen as an "X" and a much smaller "Y".

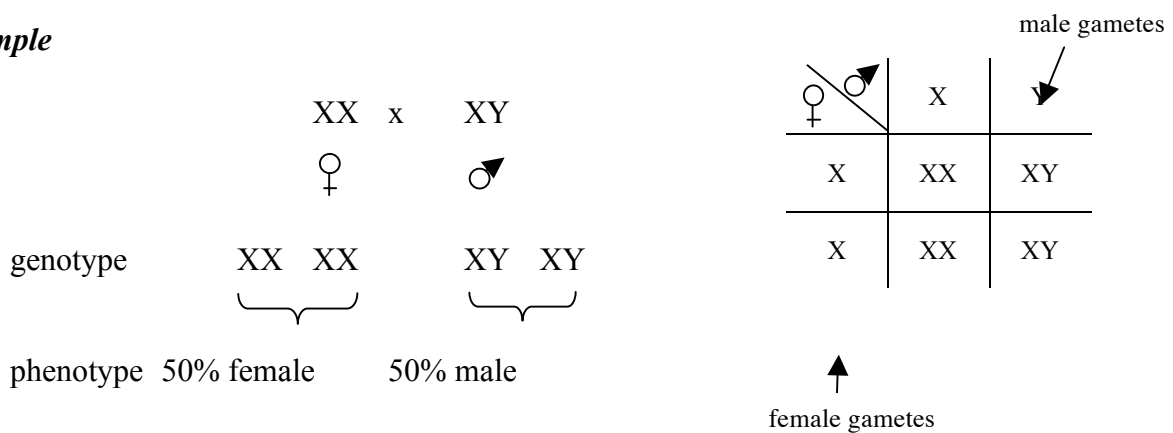
i.e. XY is a male.

Meiosis is a process that occurs in the reproductive cells of humans. It produces eggs and sperm cells with half the normal number of chromosomes (*haploid number*).

A female will produce eggs that all contain one X chromosome, while a male's sperm will have half with an X and half with a Y chromosome.

A Punnett square shows the probability of producing a boy or girl.

Example



∴ There is a 50% chance of being born male or female.

Note

Inheritance is very much determined by chance. Hence, it is possible to have 4 babies in one family being boys - contrary to the predicted ratio. The chance of a 5th baby being a boy is still 50%!